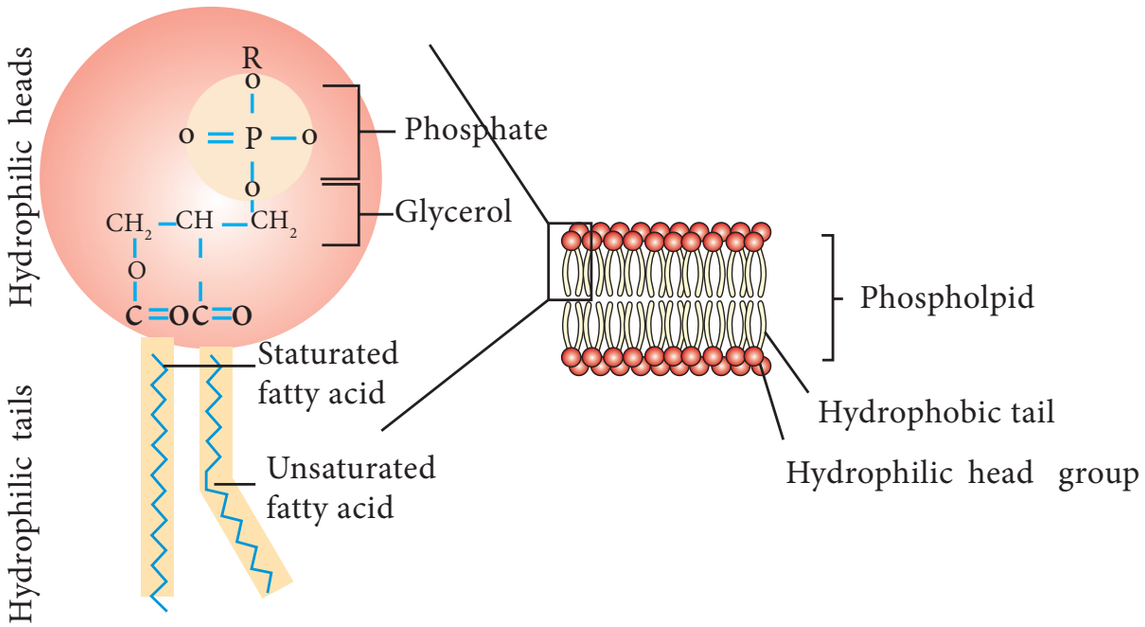


Figure 6.12 Structure of phospholipid

6.4.1 Classification:

Phospholipids are typically composed of fatty acid chains attached to a backbone of glycerol. Instead of having three fatty acid tails, phospholipids generally have two, and the hydroxyl group attached to the third carbon of the glycerol backbone is esterified by a modified phosphate group.

According to their alcohol content phospholipids are classified into two major types:

- Glycerophospholipids
- Sphingophospholipids

i. Glycero phospholipids

Glycerophospholipids are abundantly present in heart, brain, kidney, egg yolk and soyabean.

In glycerophospholipids the alcohol is glycerol, to which two fatty acids, one phosphate group and an alcohol (inositol), alcohol amine (ethanol amine, serine) or a nitrogenous base (choline) are attached. It is also known as phosphoglyceride.

There are different types of phosphoglycerides based on the attachment to the phosphate group, that confers different properties and role of the different glycerophospholipids.

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